Student and Parent Handbook

2026 to 2027 School Year

Woodbridge Islamic School

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MISSION AND VISION

Our Mission: To nurture knowledgeable, principled, and compassionate young Muslims through rigorous academics and character development rooted in the Quran and Sunnah, preparing them to serve their families, communities, and society with excellence.

Our Vision: To be a leading Islamic school where students develop strong faith, sound character, and academic excellence, becoming confident lifelong learners who contribute meaningfully to their families, the Muslim ummah, and the world.

INTRODUCTION

At Woodbridge Islamic School, we foster a supportive and inclusive environment where students can develop their critical thinking and creativity while building a strong sense of community. Our faculty and staff are dedicated to helping each student reach their full potential, both academically and personally. We provide a variety of opportunities for students to get involved and make a positive impact on their community, developing confident, responsible, and well-rounded individuals. At this school, your child will be immersed in an educational journey that is designed to help unlock their potential and ensure success.

STUDENT RIGHTS AND RESPONSIBILITIES

Student Rights

Woodbridge Islamic School respects every student. Students enjoy these rights as long as they do not infringe on the rights of others or interfere with the school's ability to provide a safe learning environment.

WIS students have the right to:

- Classrooms that foster care, nurturing, and positive relationships.
- Curriculum and instruction that provide challenging educational experiences.
- Classes that are inviting, safe, and conducive to a positive learning atmosphere for both staff and students.
- Equitable and valuable educational experiences tailored to their individual understanding and abilities.
- A fair hearing before being suspended or expelled: the chance to explain their side to the Principal, with their parents contacted, except when immediate removal is needed for safety.
- Courtesy, respect, and fairness from adults and fellow students, acknowledging their cultural beliefs and differences.

Student Expectations and Responsibilities

Student Conduct

Students will uphold the highest standards of integrity, honesty, and trustworthiness. They will cultivate and maintain a strong moral character, promoting values such as honesty, compassion, humility, patience, and empathy. Students will respect their teachers and follow given instructions. They will complete assigned homework, prioritize their studies, arrive at school punctually, and exhibit their best behavior each day.

Students hold the responsibility of contributing to an orderly and safe school environment. Any information regarding drugs, weapons, or other potentially harmful factors to individuals or the school community must be reported. Any attempted or actual retaliation for reporting violations will be addressed through corrective action, including potential expulsion.

Students possessing knowledge of drugs, weapons, violence, or other behaviors that may endanger others or the school environment may face disciplinary action for failing to report such information to school authorities.

If students discover items in their possession that are prohibited at school, they must immediately report them to an administrator or another staff member. School staff will take into account that the student proactively brought the matter to their attention. Students who believe they have information about, or have been victims of, misconduct should promptly contact an administrator, teacher, or another trusted adult.

Student Grooming and Uniform

Students are required to start the school day clean and maintain personal hygiene throughout the day. Should a student arrive without proper grooming, they will be expected to clean up before class begins.

WIS has a strict uniform policy. Students are required to wear the school uniform throughout the school day. A student who arrives out of uniform is sent to the office and the parents are contacted. The full policy is in Section C under Uniform Policy and Dress Code.

Student Care of School Environment

Students are entrusted with the care of the school environment both inside and outside the premises. They will be taught to clean up as they go, leave no trace throughout the day, and treat the school with the same respect they would show their own belongings.

Families as Partners

WIS acknowledges the crucial partnership between schools and families in creating safe, effective learning environments and nurturing the social and emotional development of children. WIS underscores the importance of positive communication between families and educators, encouraging open channels for expressing concerns, offering suggestions, and accessing information about their children. By fostering this partnership, the school community is further strengthened.

SECTION A: OPERATIONS AND POLICIES

Arrival and Departure

Doors open for students at 8:05 am. For safety reasons, students may not be dropped off before 8:05 am, and all students should be dropped off by 8:10 am. Morning assembly runs from 8:15 to 8:25 am, and all students are highly encouraged to attend. First period begins at 8:30 am. A student who arrives after 8:30 am is tardy and must be signed in at the front office by a parent or guardian. The safety of our children is critical, and strict obedience to traffic rules and traffic instructions is required.

Dismissal begins at 3:10 pm. Parents may wait in the designated area in the car rider line for their children. For safety reasons, parents are not allowed to wait in front of the classrooms. Students not picked up by 3:30 pm will go to aftercare, and families may be charged for aftercare. If you wish to speak to a teacher about specific assignments or questions, please email the teacher or make an appointment so that the teacher can give you their undivided attention.

Assemblies and Special Events

Assemblies are scheduled for educational and informational purposes throughout the school year. So that all students can enjoy and learn from these assemblies, students are to follow these rules:

- Walk to the assembly in an orderly manner as directed by duty teachers.
- Be respectful of guests and speakers.
- Upon dismissal, leave the assembly in an orderly manner as directed by teachers or staff.

During the school year, many special events will be held in your child's classroom and in other areas of the building and campus. Information about these events is available from your child's teacher, class and school newsletters, Class Dojo, the announcement board, and the school website.

Attendance

Regular attendance throughout the school day is strongly encouraged. Students must be present in class consistently to excel in their studies. We ask that students arrive on time every school day, and both parents and students should take measures to minimize tardiness whenever possible.

Reporting an Absence

- **Unplanned absence** (such as sickness or a family emergency): notify the front office by 9:30 am on the day of the absence, through Class Dojo or by calling 703-910-7029.
- **Planned absence:** inform both the front office and your child's teacher(s) in advance, giving the date and the reason. This also applies to planned late arrivals and early dismissals.
- A student who arrives after 8:30 am is tardy and must be signed in at the front office by a parent or guardian.
- A student who leaves early must be signed out at the office by a parent or guardian.

- How a long late arrival or an early dismissal is counted is decided case by case by the administration.

Excused Absences

An absence is excused when it is for one of the reasons below and the school has been told about it as described in this section:

- Illness (a doctor's note is required for absences lasting more than three days)
- Death in the family (documentation such as a funeral program is needed)
- Family emergency
- Other absences pre-approved by the Principal upon written request from a parent or guardian

Late Notice and Documentation

If the office is not notified by 9:30 am on the day of the absence, the absence is first recorded as unexcused. It will be changed to excused if, within three school days of the absence, the parent or guardian gives the office a note or documentation showing that the absence was for one of the reasons above. After three school days, the absence stays unexcused.

Unexcused Absences

A student will be marked for an unexcused absence if:

- The absence is not for one of the excused reasons above, or the office was not notified and no note or documentation was given within three school days
- The student is absent from school without parental permission
- The student leaves school without a parent or guardian signing them out at the office
- The student is absent for a family vacation during the school year (vacations are not permitted)

When a student reaches five unexcused absences, the school will contact the parent or guardian directly to make sure they are aware and to agree on a plan to reduce further absences.

Attendance and Re-Enrollment

More than 18 unexcused absences or 20 unexcused tardies in a school year may affect a student's re-enrollment. Excused late arrivals do not count toward the 20 tardies. See the Re-Enrollment Policy in Section B.

Make-Up Work

Students are responsible for all class work and homework missed during an absence. A student with an excused absence will be given the same number of days that they were absent to make up missed work. It is the student's and parent's responsibility to talk with each teacher to determine what work is required and when it needs to be completed.

Before a planned absence, students must make arrangements with all teachers for assignments. For excused absences, make-up tests will be scheduled at a time set by the teacher, and it is the student's responsibility

to take the test at that time. If a student misses the arranged time, the teacher is not obligated to set another.

Unexcused absences may affect a student's grades. Teachers are not obligated to allow make-up for quizzes, tests, class work, or homework missed during an unexcused absence.

Book Bags

Students may bring a book bag or backpack to school each day to carry school supplies, school work, and books. Please see your child's classroom teacher for specific guidelines on keeping belongings in the classroom. Backpacks left on the classroom floor are a hazard during an emergency evacuation.

Students should not bring personal items other than school supplies. This includes card games, toys, electronic equipment, soda, and similar items, which will be confiscated.

Communication

At Woodbridge Islamic School, we value the essential role that communication plays in a thriving educational environment. Open and effective communication between the school and families is the foundation of our partnership with you.

Well-informed parents can address the emotional and academic needs of their children more effectively. We keep families informed about school activities, policies, and important updates, and we share regular insight into each child's academic progress, strengths, and areas that need attention, so that learning in class can be supported at home.

Communication is also how we address behavior together. By sharing progress and concerns promptly, we invite parents to join us in encouraging responsible behavior and character development both in and out of the classroom.

Families are kept informed about safety protocols, emergency procedures, and any changes to school routines. The school communicates with families through Class Dojo, email, newsletters, and the school website. We also celebrate the many cultures within our community, and we welcome the perspectives and experiences families bring.

Technology and Internet Use Policy

At Woodbridge Islamic School, we value the responsible and safe use of technology and the internet as tools for learning, communication, and creativity. This policy outlines our guidelines for using school-provided technology and accessing the internet in a way that protects the well-being and security of everyone in our school community.

Acceptable Use

1. **Educational Purposes:** School-provided technology, including computers, tablets, and software, should be used only for educational purposes, research, and learning activities.
2. **Responsible Use:** Students are expected to behave responsibly, ethically, and respectfully while using technology and the internet, in keeping with school values and Islamic principles.

3. **Privacy and Safety:** Students should respect the privacy and safety of others and avoid sharing personal information online. Cyberbullying, harassment, and inappropriate content are strictly prohibited.

Internet Access

1. **Filtered Access:** The school's internet connection is filtered to block inappropriate and harmful content. No filtering system is foolproof, so students should immediately report any accidental access to inappropriate material to a teacher or staff member.
2. **Research and Resources:** Students are encouraged to use the internet for research under the guidance of a teacher. Reliable and reputable sources should be used for academic work.
3. **Social Media:** Students should use social media responsibly, following age restrictions and the school's values and code of conduct. Social media should not disrupt learning or violate the privacy of others.

Online Conduct

1. **Respectful Communication:** All online communication should be respectful and considerate. When a concern about students' online conduct is brought to the school, the school will look into it as it comes up.
2. **Plagiarism and Copyright:** Students should respect copyright and intellectual property when using online content for assignments. Plagiarism is unacceptable and subject to disciplinary action.
3. **Security:** Students should not share passwords, attempt to bypass security measures, or gain unauthorized access to systems, websites, or accounts.

Device Use

1. **Device Care:** Students are responsible for the care and proper use of school-provided devices and should report any technical issues or damage to a teacher or staff member.
2. **Screen Time:** While technology is a valuable tool, excessive screen time and gaming should not interfere with academic responsibilities, family time, or physical activity.

Consequences of Misuse

1. **Violation of Policy:** Violations of this policy may result in disciplinary action, loss of technology privileges, and parent notification.
2. **Legal Consequences:** Illegal activity or misuse of technology that violates the law may result in legal consequences.

Rules for cell phones and other personal electronic devices are in Section C under Personal Electronic Devices and Cell Phones.

Fire Drills, Lockdowns, and Evacuation Drills

Fire drills, lockdowns, and evacuation drills are conducted for everyone's protection. During these drills, students must remain silent, follow the teacher's instructions, and carry out all directions in an orderly fashion.

Hallways and Restrooms

Our hallways and restrooms are shared spaces, and every student contributes to a positive atmosphere through their conduct.

Hallways

1. **Respectful Movement:** Walk calmly and quietly, respecting the personal space of others.
2. **Kindness and Consideration:** Use polite language and gestures with peers and staff. Small acts of kindness, such as holding doors for others, matter.
3. **Cleanliness:** Keep hallways clean and clutter-free, and dispose of trash properly.
4. **Timeliness:** Arrive to classes promptly and do not linger in the hallways during class time.
5. **Positive Encouragement:** Lead by example and encourage others to show respect and courtesy.

Restrooms

1. **Cleanliness:** Keep restrooms clean and tidy. Dispose of trash in the bins and report any maintenance issues promptly to staff.
2. **Privacy and Respect:** Use appropriate language and behavior, wait patiently if the restroom is occupied, and always knock before entering a closed stall.
3. **Water Conservation:** Turn off faucets properly and report any leaks.
4. **Hygiene:** Wash your hands with soap and water for at least 20 seconds. Use hand sanitizer when soap is not available.
5. **Graffiti and Vandalism:** Never deface or damage restroom facilities.
6. **Emergency Awareness:** Know the emergency procedures posted in restrooms.

Health and Immunization Policy

Immunizations

Virginia law requires students at public and private schools, including preschools, to meet the Virginia Department of Health (VDH) immunization requirements. Requirements differ by age and grade, so not every vaccine below applies to every student.

Required vaccines (summary of current VDH requirements):

- **DTaP (diphtheria, tetanus, pertussis):** four doses, with at least one dose on or after the fourth birthday.
- **Tdap booster:** one dose before entering Grade 7.
- **Polio (IPV):** four doses, with at least one dose on or after the fourth birthday.
- **MMR (measles, mumps, rubella):** the first dose at 12 months of age or older and the second dose before entering Kindergarten.

- **Varicella (chickenpox):** the first dose at 12 months of age or older and the second dose before entering Kindergarten.
- **Hepatitis A:** two doses, the first at 12 months of age or older.
- **Hepatitis B:** three doses. A two-dose adult series is accepted for students aged 11 to 15 when the approved adult vaccine was used.
- **Meningococcal (MenACWY):** the first dose before entering Grade 7. (A second dose is due before Grade 12.)
- **HPV:** the first dose before entering Grade 7. Parents may choose not to have their child receive the HPV vaccine after reviewing the VDH information materials.
- **Hib and pneumococcal (PCV):** required only for children younger than five years old (60 months). The number of doses depends on the child's age when vaccination began. These apply mainly to Pre-K students.

Proof of immunization: At enrollment, parents must give the school a record of the student's immunizations, signed or certified by a healthcare provider or health department. Please ask your child's healthcare provider for this record.

Conditional enrollment: A student who has started but not completed the required doses may be enrolled conditionally if the family gives the school a written schedule for completing the remaining doses within 90 calendar days (180 calendar days when more than two hepatitis B doses are still needed). A student who does not keep to the schedule may not attend school until the immunizations are resumed.

Exemptions:

- **Medical:** a written certification from a licensed physician, a licensed advanced practice registered nurse, or a local health department stating that one or more vaccines may be detrimental to the student's health, and the nature and probable duration of the condition.
- **Religious:** a parent or guardian may submit the VDH Certificate of Religious Exemption stating that immunization conflicts with the family's religious tenets or practices. A religious exemption does not apply when the State Board of Health has declared an emergency or epidemic of disease.

The full, current requirements and forms are published by the Virginia Department of Health. Families are responsible for keeping their child's record up to date as new doses become due, especially before Kindergarten and before Grade 7.

Illness

Students who are sick should stay home. A student with a fever of 100.4 degrees or higher, vomiting, or another contagious illness should not come to school and may return once they have been fever-free for 24 hours without fever-reducing medication. If a student becomes ill during the school day, parents will be called to pick them up.

Allergies

Any allergies must be reported to the school. Severe allergies will be shared with the administration and the student's teachers to keep the student safe. WIS is a nut-free school. Students may not bring nuts or foods containing nuts for snacks or lunch.

Medication

WIS does not currently authorize any staff member to give medication to students. This applies to every kind of medication: prescription, over-the-counter (such as pain or fever relievers and cough medicine), and emergency medication.

Medication Given by Parents

- If your child needs medication during the school day, a parent or guardian must come to school and give it to the child at the front office.
- Students may not carry, take, or share medication at school, except as described below.

Medication Students Carry and Use Themselves

A student may carry and use their own emergency medication, such as an asthma inhaler or epinephrine auto-injector (EpiPen), only if both of these conditions are met:

- It is necessary because of a potentially life-threatening condition and has been recommended by the student's physician, and
- The office has a signed letter on file from the student's parent, physician, and an administrator.

The student uses this medication themselves. Staff do not give it.

Health Plans

Please tell the school about any medical condition that may need attention during the school day. If your child has a written emergency or health plan from a doctor (for example, for severe allergies, asthma, diabetes, or seizures), give a copy to the office before your child starts school and meet with the administration to review it. If the plan calls for staff to give medication, the administration will discuss with you, before your child attends, how your child's needs will be met under this policy.

Medical Emergencies

In a medical emergency, staff will call 911 and then contact the parent or guardian.

Littering

At Woodbridge Islamic School, we take pride in a clean and welcoming campus, and every student plays a part in keeping it that way. Littering detracts from the beauty of our school, creates safety hazards, and undermines the sense of unity we work to build.

- **Use the bins:** Dispose of waste in the trash and recycling bins provided throughout the school.
- **Mind common areas:** Keep hallways, the lunch area, and outdoor spaces litter-free.

- **Lead by example:** When others see you dispose of waste responsibly, they are more likely to do the same.
- **Encourage others:** Gently remind classmates to keep the school clean.

Lost and Found

There is a designated area in the building for lost and found items. Books, clothing, and personal items found on school grounds will be taken there. At the end of each semester, unclaimed items will be donated to charity. Please label all of your child's belongings.

Lunch and Snack Periods

We are committed to the well-being of our students, and healthy eating habits nourish both the mind and the body. We encourage families to pack balanced, nourishing lunches and snacks.

- **Variety:** Include whole grains, lean proteins, fruits, vegetables, and dairy.
- **Homemade:** Whenever possible, choose homemade meals and snacks.
- **Portion size:** Pack balanced portions that satisfy without causing sluggishness.
- **Fruits and vegetables:** Make them a colorful part of every lunch.
- **Water:** Make water the main drink of the day and limit sugary beverages.
- **Smart snacks:** Choose snacks such as whole-grain crackers, cheese, yogurt, and fresh fruit that give steady energy without excess sugar or salt.
- **Nut-free:** WIS is a nut-free school. Students may not bring nuts or foods containing nuts for snacks or lunch.

Parking

All visitors to campus must respect the accessible (handicap) parking spaces. Please do not park in areas that interfere with student drop-off and pick-up.

Office Telephones

Students may use the office phone for emergencies only. We encourage students to know their schedule before arriving in the morning and to plan after-school activities and transportation with their families in advance, so that calls during the school day are not needed.

Transportation

WIS does not provide transportation. Students and their families must make their own arrangements for travel to and from school.

Visitors

Visitors on campus for educational purposes are warmly welcomed. For safety and accountability, all parents and visitors must register at the main office on arrival and wear the visitor pass they are given for the whole visit.

Parent Visits During School Hours

We value parent involvement and welcome pre-arranged visits during school hours. To protect the learning environment, we ask parents to follow these guidelines:

- **Scheduling visits:** Schedule visits with the administration and your child's teacher in advance.
- **Respectful interaction:** Do not interrupt teachers during instruction.
- **Visitor badges:** Wear your visitor badge at all times while on campus.
- **Teacher meetings:** Schedule meetings with teachers directly, at a time convenient for both of you.
- **Classroom guidelines:** Follow the classroom rules set by the teacher while visiting.
- **Other students:** Do not address or discipline other students. Please bring any concerns to school staff.
- **Fairness:** Please do not show favoritism toward your own child during a visit; all students follow the same rules and procedures.
- **Signing out:** Sign out at the main office when your visit ends.

SECTION B: ACADEMICS

Academic Placement of Students

We believe each student's potential is academic, emotional, social, and physical. Placement decisions consider:

- **Academic proficiency:** placement tests, previous school records, and assessment results.
- **Personal interview:** insight into the student's aspirations, interests, and readiness.
- **Age and maturity:** fit with the designated class.

All enrollments at WIS are conditional, pending review of previous school records. Students with a history of expulsion, or who are currently suspended from their previous school, may be refused enrollment at WIS.

New students take placement tests in English and Mathematics. For Pre-K, Kindergarten, and Grade 1, both academic and social readiness guide placement. WIS reserves the right to withdraw enrollment if false information was provided during the application process.

Placement decisions are also informed by work and study habits, academic achievement and skill mastery, physical and social development, emotional maturity, interests in curricular and extracurricular activities, attendance, chronological age, classroom dynamics, and future educational goals.

Parents who disagree with a placement decision are encouraged to write to the school administration, who will review it carefully.

Awards

Awards are decided by the faculty and the Principal and presented at the Award Ceremony in June. They may include:

- **Subject Excellence:** excelling in a subject such as mathematics, science, literature, art, Islamic Studies, or Quran.
- **Leadership:** taking initiative and inspiring peers.
- **Citizenship:** consistently good character, respect for others, and positive behavior.
- **Community Service:** active volunteer work and service to others.
- **Most Improved:** significant improvement in academics, attitude, or behavior.
- **Perfect Attendance:** attending every school day during a set period.
- **Sportsmanship:** fair play and positive behavior in sports and physical activities.
- **Performing Arts:** excelling in recitation, speech, drama, or other performing disciplines.
- **Character:** integrity, respect, responsibility, and empathy.
- **Environmental Stewardship:** contributing to conservation and caring for the environment.
- **Peer Mentorship:** guiding and supporting fellow students.

- **Academic Achievement:** outstanding academic work across the year.
- **Perseverance:** overcoming challenges and showing resilience.

Promotion Policy

A student is promoted to the next grade after earning a passing grade of 60% or higher, averaged across both semesters, in each of English, Social Studies, Science, and Mathematics. Promotion is also based on mastery of grade-level standards, attendance, discipline records, and overall readiness for the next grade. WIS reserves the right to retain a student when the administration determines that promotion would not be in the student's best educational interest. The final decision on promotion or retention rests with the school administration.

Re-Enrollment Policy

Re-enrollment at WIS is not guaranteed. Each year, every family signs the WIS Family and Student Agreement, and a student's place for the following year depends on meeting its expectations. WIS reserves the right to deny re-enrollment to any student whose academic record, conduct, attendance, or family cooperation does not meet the standards below.

Academic Standards

- Students must maintain an overall average of 75% or above across all subjects.
- An overall average below 75% may result in academic probation, required tutoring, or ineligibility for re-enrollment.
- A student who is not promoted under the Promotion Policy may not be offered re-enrollment.
- **How the two standards fit together:** 60% in each core subject is the minimum to be promoted to the next grade. A 75% overall average is the standard for continuing at WIS. A student can earn promotion and still fall below 75% overall, and that student may be placed on academic probation, required to attend tutoring, or not offered re-enrollment.
- The Principal makes the final decision on academic probation, tutoring, and re-enrollment. These decisions cannot be appealed to the Board.

Behavior and Conduct

- Respectful behavior is required at all times, and students must follow this handbook.
- Repeated misconduct, serious infractions, or bullying will lead to disciplinary action and may result in removal from school.
- A student suspended during the school year may be denied re-enrollment for the following year.

Islamic Manners and Etiquette

- Students are expected to show Islamic values in speech, actions, and appearance.
- Kindness, honesty, cleanliness, humility, and respect for teachers, staff, and peers are required at all times.

Uniform and Modesty

- WIS has a strict uniform policy. Students must wear the approved uniform every day, including at special events unless the school says otherwise.
- Uniforms must be clean, neat, modest, loose-fitting, non-transparent, and consistent with Islamic principles. The full requirements are in Section C under Uniform Policy and Dress Code.

Attendance and Punctuality

- Regular attendance and punctuality are essential.
- More than 18 unexcused absences or 20 unexcused tardies in a school year may affect re-enrollment.
- Vacations during the school year are not permitted and are counted as unexcused absences.

Parental Responsibility

- Parents and guardians must actively monitor their child's grades, assignments, attendance, and behavior using the tools the school provides, including Class Dojo.
- Cooperation between home and school is vital. A family's failure to work with the school may affect re-enrollment.

The Family and Student Agreement

- Each family completes and signs the Family and Student Agreement and returns it to the child's homeroom teacher.
- By signing, parents agree to these conditions and understand that failure to meet them may result in their child not being re-enrolled for the following school year.

Homework Policy

Homework consolidates classroom learning, builds independent study habits, and opens conversations between students, parents, and teachers. Assignments are designed to respect students' need for family, physical, and recreational time. Each teacher may have their own policy on late work, so please become familiar with it.

Teachers will

- Give students a clear homework policy, including deadlines and consequences.
- Design assignments that reinforce classroom learning.
- Keep the workload reasonable.
- Check homework promptly and give timely feedback.
- Make sure students have the resources they need to complete assignments.

Students will

- Make up work missed because of absences.
- Understand the purpose, requirements, grading, and due date of each assignment.

- Take care with the content, structure, and presentation of their work.
- Manage their time and gather the materials they need.
- Meet deadlines and understand the effect of late or missing work.
- Ask their teacher for help when something is unclear.

Parents can

- Set aside a regular daily time for homework.
- Encourage quality and completion, emphasizing learning over grades.
- Contact the teacher about any unresolved concerns.
- Model respect toward teachers, administrators, other parents, and students.

Supplies

Students should always come to class with the correct supplies. The supply list is posted on the school website.

SECTION C: DISCIPLINE

School Tardiness

Prompt attendance makes the most of every learning opportunity. Doors open at 8:05 am, students should be dropped off by 8:10 am, morning assembly runs from 8:15 to 8:25 am, and first period begins at 8:30 am. A student who arrives after 8:30 am is tardy and must be signed in at the front office by a parent or guardian, as late arrivals disrupt learning for other students.

To excuse a late arrival, one of the following must be given to the office:

- A note from a parent or guardian explaining the reason for the late arrival.
- A note from a teacher or staff member stating the reason, such as a delay caused by a school activity.

Excessive tardiness will lead to a parent conference to agree on improvements. After that conference, further late arrivals will be recorded as unexcused. Chronic tardiness is a significant concern: parents will be informed after each incident, and ongoing tardiness will carry additional consequences. This policy is applied consistently throughout the school year.

More than 20 unexcused tardies in a school year may affect a student's re-enrollment. Excused late arrivals do not count toward this limit. The attendance and absence rules are in Section A under Attendance.

Uniform Policy and Dress Code

A modest and respectful appearance supports a positive, focused learning environment. Our uniform and dress code reflect Islamic values while promoting unity and equality among students.

General Guidelines

1. **Uniform requirement:** WIS has a strict uniform policy. All students must wear the school-approved uniform every school day and at school events, unless the school announces otherwise in advance.
2. **Modesty:** All clothing should be loose-fitting, non-transparent, and cover the body appropriately.
3. **Cleanliness and neatness:** Uniforms should be clean, ironed, and well maintained.

Requirements for All Students

- Dress shoes in black or dark brown are required. No sneakers, sandals, or casual footwear, except athletic shoes for PE (see Exceptions below).
- No accessories or clothing items outside the approved uniform may be worn.
- Jackets, hoodies, and other outerwear may not be worn inside the building during the school day. The official WIS logo cardigan is the only exception.

Boys' Uniform (Pre-K to Grade 8)

- Top: Flynn O'Hara WIS logo polo, short or long sleeve, white or navy
- Pants: khaki dress pants (no joggers or jeans)

- Cardigan: WIS logo cardigan (optional, encouraged in colder months)
- Shoes: dress shoes (no athletic or casual footwear)

Girls' Uniform (Pre-K to Grade 8)

- Top: white long-sleeved button-down shirt
- Jumper: Flynn O'Hara-approved plaid jumper
- Pants: loose-fitting black pants worn under the jumper
- Cardigan: WIS logo cardigan (optional, encouraged in colder months)
- Hijab: solid black hijab (see When the Hijab Is Required below)
- Shoes: dress shoes (no open-toe or casual shoes)

Girls' Abaya Option (Grades 1 to 8)

- Girls in Grades 1 to 8 may wear a plain navy blue abaya, loose-fitting and ankle-length, instead of the jumper uniform. The white shirt and black pants are not required under the abaya. This option is not available in Pre-K or Kindergarten.
- Dress shoes are still required, and the black hijab is worn as set out below.

When the Hijab Is Required

- **Grades 3 to 8:** the solid black hijab is mandatory at all times during the school day.
- **Pre-K to Grade 2:** the solid black hijab must be worn in Islamic Studies and Quran classes, and girls are encouraged to wear it at all other times.
- Parents and students may consult the administration for guidance.

Exceptions

1. **Dress-down days, special events, and field trips:** students may wear clothing other than the uniform only when the school has announced it in advance through Class Dojo. Clothing must still be modest, loose-fitting, and non-transparent, and the hijab rules above still apply.
2. **Physical education:** there is no separate PE uniform. Students wear their regular uniform and may wear athletic shoes (sneakers) for physical education classes.
3. **Hair and grooming:** hair should be clean, well groomed, and of natural colors. Extreme hairstyles and hair colors are discouraged.

When a Student Is Out of Uniform

1. The student is sent to the office.
2. The office contacts the parent or guardian, who may be required to bring the correct uniform before the student returns to class.
3. Repeated uniform violations may lead to detention (see the Detention Policy) and are considered for re-enrollment.

We ask for parents' support in making sure students follow the dress code, and invite you to contact the administration with any concerns or special circumstances.

Personal Electronic Devices and Cell Phones

1. **Prohibited devices:** Radios, cameras, camcorders, audio recorders, laptops, electronic games, smartwatches, and similar devices may not be used or carried on school premises during school hours, whatever their intended use. Devices found will be confiscated and returned only to a parent or guardian. Cell phones are the one exception, as set out below.
2. **Cell phones:** Students may not have or use cell phones during the school day. A student who brings a phone to school must hand it in at the front office when they arrive, and it is returned at dismissal. A phone that is not handed in, or is seen in use, will be confiscated and returned only to a parent or guardian, and repeated violations may lead to detention.
3. **Photos and recordings:** Taking pictures or recording video on campus requires prior approval from the administration.
4. **Personal property:** WIS cannot take responsibility for the loss of students' personal property, including confiscated items.
5. **Retrieving confiscated items:** Parents or guardians should collect confiscated items within one week, or by the last day of the school year at the latest. After that, unclaimed items are no longer the responsibility of WIS.

Student Conduct and Discipline

At WIS, our first goal is to help each student reach their intellectual, social, physical, and emotional potential, in an environment that supports learning and is free from distraction.

Our teachers encourage positive behavior in the classroom using redirection, active engagement, individual behavior contracts, and parent conferences, so that every student experiences a positive learning atmosphere.

WIS is known for a disciplined, structured, and calm atmosphere marked by respect, courtesy, friendliness, and positivity. Teachers establish school-wide and classroom rules and actively teach the school's code of conduct. We believe that building discipline means building respect, responsibility, and empathy.

Consequences for inappropriate behavior are clearly stated and consistently applied. The behaviors listed in this handbook as leading to detention, suspension, or expulsion are examples and are not a complete list.

Detention Policy

A student may be given lunch or after-school detention for breaking school rules, at the discretion of the administration. Detention may be given for:

- **Disrespect:** blatant disrespect toward teachers, staff, or volunteers, including ignoring their corrections.

- **Refusing a reasonable request:** failing to follow a reasonable request from any school employee or adult assigned to the school.
- **Tardiness:** repeatedly arriving late to class or school without a valid reason.
- **Minor disruptions:** low-level disruption in class, such as talking out of turn or not following classroom rules.
- **Uniform or dress code violations.**
- **Inappropriate language** toward peers, teachers, or staff.
- **Cell phone use** or use of other electronic devices.
- **Hallway behavior:** running, pushing, or other disruptive behavior between classes.
- **Misuse of school property:** damaging or misusing school property, equipment, or facilities in a minor way.
- **Missing an assigned detention.**
- **Minor pranks** that do not cause harm or significant disruption.
- **Lunch area rules:** cutting in line, creating a mess, or similar behavior.
- **Unauthorized leave:** leaving class or the school premises without permission.
- **Library behavior:** excessive noise or inappropriate behavior in the library.
- **Inappropriate use of technology** not permitted by the school's technology policy.
- **Ignoring instructions** from teachers or school staff.
- **Disruption in assemblies** or school gatherings.
- **Minor vandalism** or defacing property.
- **Other minor infractions** of the code of conduct that still need to be addressed.

Suspension Policy

A student involved in serious misconduct or repeated misbehavior may be suspended from school. As a private school, WIS follows its own process, set out below.

Conduct That May Lead to Suspension

- Violations of the law
- Serious or repeated violations of school rules
- Acts that are harmful, potentially harmful, disruptive, or damaging to people, property, or the school program
- Continued disobedience after earlier consequences

How a Suspension Is Decided

1. **Referral:** Teachers and staff refer serious discipline matters to the administration. Only the Principal may suspend a student.
2. **Hearing the student:** The student is told what they are accused of and is given the chance to explain their side before any decision is made.
3. **Contacting parents:** The Principal contacts the parents or guardians before the suspension begins, except where an immediate removal is needed for safety.
4. **Written notice:** Parents receive a letter stating the reason for the suspension, how many school days it lasts, and the date the student may return.
5. **Return meeting:** Before returning, the student and a parent or guardian meet with the Principal to agree on expectations going forward.

Length of a Suspension

- A suspension lasts from one to ten school days, set by the Principal according to the seriousness of the conduct.
- For students in Pre-K to Grade 3, suspension is a last resort and lasts no more than five school days, unless the conduct caused or seriously threatened physical harm.
- If the student's presence poses an immediate danger, the student may be removed at once, with parents contacted and the reasons explained as soon as possible.
- Conduct serious enough to call for more than ten days out of school is reviewed for expulsion.

During a Suspension

A suspended student may not attend classes, take part in extracurricular activities or school events, or be on school premises. The student may complete graded work during and after the suspension. The suspension is recorded in the student's file, and a student suspended during the school year may be denied re-enrollment for the following year.

Expulsion

Expulsion is the permanent withdrawal of a student from Woodbridge Islamic School. Repeated offenses may lead to expulsion, even when no single offense would lead to expulsion on its own.

Conduct That May Lead to Expulsion

- Bringing a weapon, firearm, explosive, or illegal substance to school
- Assault, sexual assault, or arson
- Criminal or gang-related activity
- Conduct that seriously endangers the safety of students or staff
- Repeated serious misconduct after earlier suspensions

- Repeated offenses of any kind under this handbook, including after warnings, detentions, behavior contracts, or parent conferences

How an Expulsion Is Decided

1. The student may be suspended while the matter is reviewed.
2. The Principal reviews the facts, hears from the student, and meets with the parents or guardians before any decision is made.
3. The decision to expel is made by the Principal in consultation with the Director, and is given to the parents in writing with the reasons.
4. An expelled student may not return to WIS. Tuition and fees follow the school's tuition policy.

Appeals

Parents or guardians may appeal a suspension or an expulsion by writing to the WIS Board within five school days of receiving the decision. The Board will review the written record, may meet with the family, and will give its decision in writing. The Board's decision is final. The student remains out of school while an appeal is reviewed.

Admission After Discipline Elsewhere

WIS may refuse admission to a student who has been expelled from another school or is currently suspended from one.

Search and Inspection of Student Belongings

To keep the school safe, it is WIS policy that school staff may inspect school property, such as desks and cubbies, at any time. Any illegal, unauthorized, or prohibited items found will be confiscated.

Students may also be asked to show the contents of their personal belongings, including backpacks, when a teacher or administrator has reason to believe that harmful, dangerous, or prohibited items may be present. Refusing to cooperate with an inspection or search may lead to disciplinary action under the code of conduct.

Violations of Local, State, or Federal Law

Students who break local, state, or federal law will face school discipline. WIS may report the matter to the appropriate law enforcement agency and will cooperate with law enforcement. Violations include, but are not limited to:

- **Physical assault:** deliberately causing, or attempting to cause, harm to another person through force or violence.
- **Verbal assault:** making intentional spoken or written threats to harm another person, creating a reasonable fear of injury.
- **Arson:** intentionally setting fire to, or attempting to set fire to, any building, structure, or property.

- **Theft:** stealing school or personal property.
- **Intimidation:** any threat by a student toward another student or staff member, whether physical or verbal.
- **Extortion:** taking money or valuables from a student under any expressed or implied threat. To prevent misunderstandings, students may not borrow money or valuables unless a teacher or staff member has approved it in advance.
- **Weapons or explosives:** possessing, using, or threatening to use any weapon capable of causing bodily harm, or possessing or using snap pops, smoke bombs, firecrackers, or any other explosive materials.
- **Threats:** false bomb threats or false reports of fire to the school or the police will lead to police involvement and school discipline. Calling them jokes does not lessen the offense.
- **Vandalism:** willfully destroying property belonging to others or to the school.
- **Trespassing:** entering school premises without permission after being told not to by the Principal or their representative. Everyone on school grounds must follow the Principal's requests and any signs restricting entry.
- **Other illegal acts:** any act that is illegal under local, state, or federal law, or that disrupts the educational process or endangers anyone's safety.

SECTION D: EXTRACURRICULAR ACTIVITIES

Clubs and After-School Activities

Clubs and after-school activities led by teachers are a valuable way to extend a student's education. Most after-school schedules are announced at the start of each school year. To take part, students must follow these guidelines:

- Students must be supervised by a teacher or another responsible staff member for the whole activity.
- Parents must pick students up on time when the activity ends.
- Students must follow the WIS code of conduct throughout the activity.
- Students must check in with the supervising teacher or staff member. Staff are not obligated to look for students who do not attend.
- Physical activities carry some risk of injury. Any waiver or release for a particular activity will be given to parents separately to review and sign.

Field Trips

Field trips are exciting ways to learn, and WIS students will have several during the school year. Students must show responsible behavior at school to be eligible for off-campus trips, and on every trip they must follow these guidelines:

- **Permission form:** Students must return the field trip permission form, signed by a parent or guardian, by the due date. Verbal permission by phone will not be accepted.
- **Conduct:** Students must follow the WIS code of conduct throughout the trip.
- **Eligibility:** Students with multiple discipline referrals to the office in the current quarter may not join field trips. A teacher may also ask the administration to exclude a student who consistently presents serious behavior challenges.
- **Parent drivers:** Parent drivers must turn in all required paperwork, such as a copy of their driver's license and insurance card, before the day of the trip.

STUDENT CONDUCT CONTRACT

Every student at Woodbridge Islamic School enjoys the privileges of our school community and carries obligations to its other members. Please read the contract below, and through the year, conduct yourself in ways that enrich your own learning and the learning of others.

As a student of Woodbridge Islamic School, I commit to:

- Being thoughtful of the rights and feelings of others, and taking care not to cause physical or emotional harm.
- Speaking and behaving respectfully, without profanity or insulting language.
- Taking responsible care of my belongings and the belongings of others.
- Always asking permission before borrowing anything, and returning it promptly.
- Attending school every day and arriving on time.
- Arriving in class on time with all the materials I need.
- Using class time well, completing assignments, and meeting deadlines.
- Taking responsibility for work I miss when I am absent.
- Staying on school premises during school hours, including lunch.
- Doing my best work, respecting the work of others, and keeping my own work honest.
- Asking for help when I do not understand a lesson or instruction.
- Never bringing prohibited, threatening, or dangerous items to school.
- Helping keep the school building and grounds clean and orderly.
- Following the uniform and dress code.
- Avoiding any behavior the school's rules prohibit.

Students sign this contract on the Handbook Acknowledgment page that follows.

HANDBOOK ACKNOWLEDGMENT

Please sign and return this page to your child's homeroom teacher.

I have read the Woodbridge Islamic School Student and Parent Handbook, including the Student Conduct Contract, and agree to follow the rules it states. I understand the consequences of not following the rules, and I have been given the opportunity to discuss any questions I have about school policies.

Parent Printed Name	Parent Signature	Date

Student Printed Name	Student Signature	Date

Homeroom Teacher	Grade